CASE STUDY

CANDIDATE BRIEF

Head of DevOps & Analytics

Role focus

Azure DevOps • GitHub Enterprise • Microsoft Fabric • Agile Work Management • Platform Engineering • Engineering Analytics • AI Ops

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1. SCENARIO

You are leading a global engineering transformation. The organization is migrating repositories and CI/CD from multiple Azure DevOps organizations to one GitHub Enterprise instance, while retaining Azure Boards for Agile Work Management in one ADO organization, building trusted engineering analytics in Microsoft Fabric, supporting both a distributed environment as well as a consolidated end-state environment. AI-enabled engineering practices should be implemented where applicable.

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2. ASSIGNMENT

PART A: PLATFORM ENGINEERING

- Create a working .NET 8 sample repository.
- Convert the supplied Azure Pipeline to GitHub Actions for pull-request validation.
- Build, test, collect coverage, upload relevant artifacts, and apply appropriate permissions.
- Include one reusable workflow, composite action, or comparable platform pattern.
- Document security, governance, migration, validation, rollback, and key trade-offs.

PART B: DATA ENGINEERING

- Use the supplied DORA metrics data in Excel.
- Build a focused Microsoft Fabric Bronze, Silver, and Gold solution.
- Create a baseline dashboard showing DORA metrics Deployment Frequency, Lead Time for Changes, Change Failure Rate and Mean Time to Restore.
- Define metric grain, formulas, sources, rules, ownership, and limitations.
- Implement three executable data-quality checks.

PART C: STRATEGY AND LEADERSHIP

- Your task is to migrate, consolidate and improve an Azure DevOps environment with 5 ADO organizations, 1000 repositories, 1500 pipelines and immature DevOps practices.
- Provide a 12-month DevOps and Analytics roadmap and prioritized 90-day plan.
- Describe the target operating model, IDP product model, migration waves, governance, trusted metrics, and AI Ops or Agentic DevOps opportunities.
- Explain priorities, investments, exceptions, risks, and what should be stopped or deferred.

PART D: EXECUTIVE RECOMMENDATION

Assume repository migration is ahead of plan, pipeline conversion is behind, Security wants stronger enforcement, some legacy products cannot use standard runners, metric quality is disputed, and developers report added friction. Recommend whether to accelerate, pause, or re-scope, and identify the decisions required from executive stakeholders.

> **What this assesses**
>
> Your hands-on platform and data engineering capability, enterprise strategy, governance, decision-making, and executive communication.

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3. DELIVERABLES

Deliverable	Limit / expectation
GitHub repository	Source, workflows, tests, Fabric artifacts where exportable, sample data, quality checks, README, and review instructions.
Strategy package	Maximum 10 pages covering architecture, operating model, governance, roadmap, risks, and decisions.
Executive presentation	Maximum 5 slides for CTO, Engineering, Product, and Security leadership.
Executive recommendation	Maximum 1 page, including priorities, investment choices, trusted metrics, risks, and decisions.
Demonstration	Maximum 30 minutes, followed by questions. Demonstrate one working vertical slice end to end.

4. TIME LIMITS

Preparation time

Spend no more than 8 hours on this exercise. We assess judgment, technical depth, focus, and communication, not who invests the most time.

Interview segment	Maximum time
Candidate presentation	20 minutes
Technical demonstration	20 minutes
Panel questions and discussion	20 minutes
Total final-stage session	60 minutes

If you cannot implement a capability because of licensing or personal-environment limits, document the proposed enterprise design and clearly distinguish it from implemented functionality.

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5. SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

- Submit one accessible GitHub repository URL.
- Add the executive presentation in PPTX or PDF format.
- Add the strategy package and one-page recommendation in PDF format.
- Place all supporting material in the repository under a clearly named /docs folder, or provide one shared folder link.
- Include a root README.md with setup, prerequisites, assumptions, architecture summary, how to run the workflow, how to review Fabric artifacts, and known limitations.
- Ensure reviewers can access the repository and documents without requesting additional permissions.
- Remove all credentials, tokens, company-confidential data, and personal information.
- Clearly label synthetic or generated data.
- Include the commit hash or release tag representing the final submission.
- Submit by the deadline stated in your interview invitation. Late submissions may be reviewed only at the panel's discretion.

6. USE OF AI

AI tools are allowed and encouraged. Include a short AI Use Statement naming the tools used, the areas where they contributed significantly, and how you validated the output. You must be able to explain and defend all submitted code, designs, metrics, and recommendations.

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7. EVALUATION

Area	Weight
Platform Engineering	25%
Data Engineering and Microsoft Fabric	25%
Strategy and Operating Model	20%
Migration and Governance	15%
Executive Communication	10%
Documentation Quality	5%

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

- A small, working, reproducible solution rather than excessive scope.
- Defensible technical and strategic decisions with explicit trade-offs.
- Clear metric definitions and traceability from source data to executive reporting.
- Practical enterprise thinking across security, reliability, cost, adoption, and developer experience.
- Clear separation between implemented features, proposed capabilities, assumptions, and limitations.

8. FINAL SUBMISSION CHECKLIST

☐ Repository access verified

☐ Workflow run evidence included

☐ Fabric review instructions included

☐ Three data-quality checks implemented

☐ Strategy package within 10 pages

☐ Presentation within 5 slides

☐ Executive recommendation within 1 page

☐ AI Use Statement included

☐ Synthetic data labelled

☐ Secrets and confidential data removed

☐ Final commit hash or release tag supplied

Review principle

A focused and well-reasoned submission is preferred over a large or highly complex implementation.

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